

Sustainability Support for Education

Guide for working with groups of settings

Purpose of this guide

This guide will show you:

- How the Sustainability Support for Education site works
- How to get the most out of it for your context
- Make suggestions on how you can use it to achieve your goals
- How you could use the site to start to think more strategically about your group's and schools' climate action
- Inspire you with case studies

This guide will be useful to you if you are a Group, MAT or Diocese that is:

- Looking to develop your central sustainability plans
- Looking to support your settings in developing climate action
- Looking to give your settings central direction
- Trying to understand better where your setting are on their sustainability journey
- Trying to get a better handle of what your settings are doing when it comes to climate action

Sustainability Support for Education

This website, [Sustainability Support for Education](#), has been built to support you and your settings to take climate action.

- On it, you will find that **ACTIONS** to include in your **CLIMATE ACTION PLAN**
- And you will find the best **RESOURCES** available to help you to implement those actions.

A Climate Action Plan should be proportionate to where each setting is, it is about helping them to identify and take the next steps that are right for them.

This guide will help you to get the most out of the site for you and your settings.

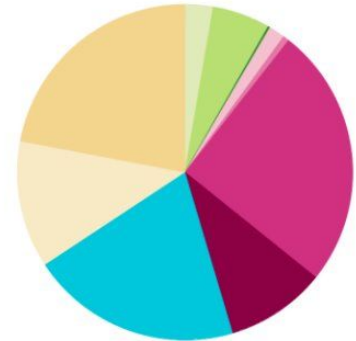
Taking Climate Action

What is Climate Action

- Reduce emissions
- Drive behavioural change and shifting mindsets
- Developing resilience to the effects of an ever changing climate
- Creating a better, greener world for future generations
- Enhancing our natural surroundings
- Increasing access to, and connection with nature

Your schools total carbon footprint is estimated to be: 383.72 tonnes co₂e* per year

Operational area	Emissions area	t co ₂ e*	% of footprint
Energy & Utilities	Fuel Usage	10.2	3%
	Electricity Usage	21.3	6%
	Waste Usage	0.1	0%
	Water Usage	0.6	<1%
Transport	Vehicles	5.8	2%
	School Trips	2.1	<1%
	Student Commutes	96.4	25%
	Staff Commutes	36.8	10%
Food & Drink	Meals	77.9	20%
Purchases	Spending	47	12%
	Uniforms	85.5	22%



*'t co₂e' or 'co₂e' tonnes means 'tonnes of Carbon Dioxide Equivalent'. Under the GHG protocol, 7 greenhouse gases are tracked and summarised as the equivalent amount of Carbon Dioxide that would produce the same warming effect.

Taking Climate Action

Why have a Climate Action Plan

- DfE want all schools (and groups) to have one. Depending on your size, you may choose to have one for your whole group, or one for each school.
- Evidence shows that taking climate action will have lots of wider benefits for your setting such as:
 - financial savings from energy efficiency;
 - mental health and wellbeing through outdoor learning;
 - improving the school infrastructure and estate.
- A whole-institution approach to sustainability can effectively demonstrate compliance with various aspects of the Education Inspection Framework.

How the site works

Watch a step by step guide on how to use the site [HERE](#).

Your free online expert-backed Climate Action Hub

A fast, easy, and high-quality platform to help every education setting build their Climate Action Plans:

- ✓ **Quick** – Built for busy staff
- ✓ **Simple** – Everything in one place
- ✓ **Trusted** – The very best resources, expert-checked

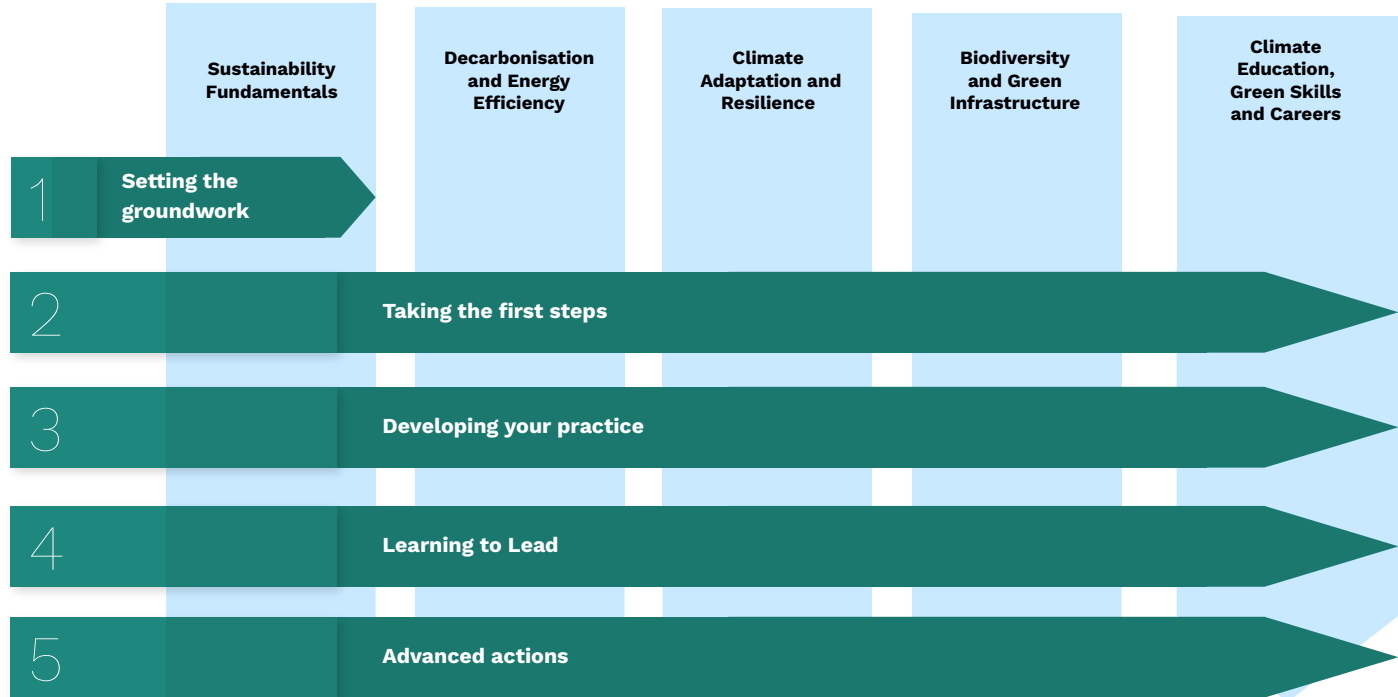
Start and progress on your sustainability journey today – **all in this one stop shop.**

Foundations of the site

The actions you will find on the site are based on increasing maturity as you progress on your Sustainability Journey

Sustainability Support for Education Maturity Stages

Department for Education Strategy Pillars



The sustainability journey

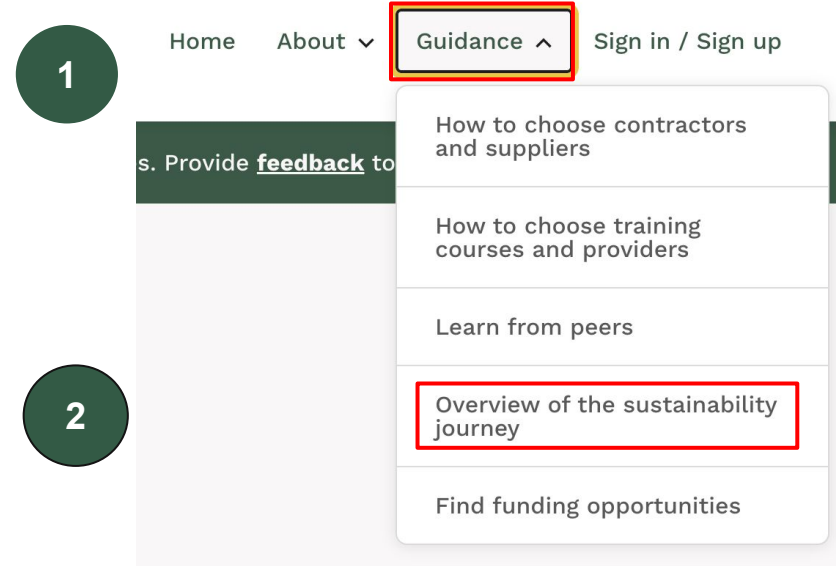
Overview

To support settings to explore where they are on their sustainability journey and what lies ahead, we have visualised a structured sustainability journey.

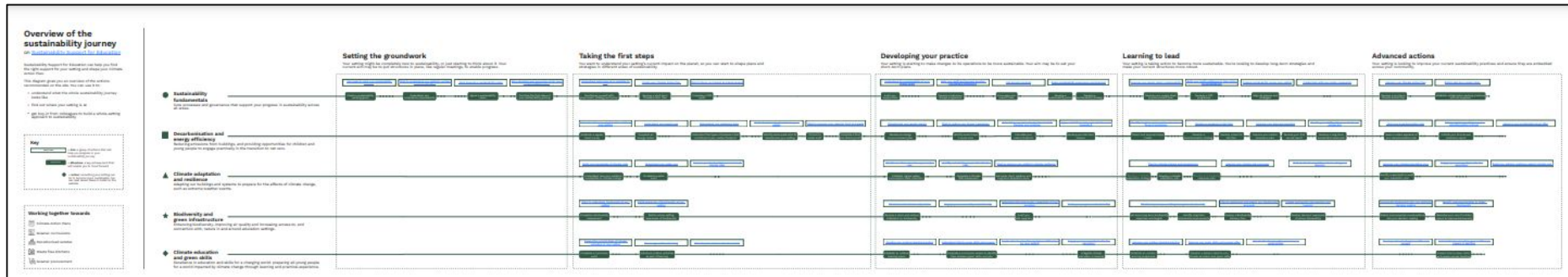
This journey is built around aims, which are groups of related actions arranged in a logical sequence, supporting settings to follow a clear path towards sustainability.

Rather than focusing on individual actions in isolation, this approach provides a strategic framework that supports long-term progress.

The next page provides a snapshot of the journey.



The sustainability journey



Key

Sample text

= **Aim:** a group of actions that will help you progress in your sustainability journey

Sample text

= **Milestone:** a key achievement that will enable you to move forward

= **Action:** something your setting can do to become more sustainable. You can read about these in detail on the website.

The sustainability journey

Getting the most from the sustainability journey

- Familiarise yourself with the key characteristics of each stage.
- Use the visual as a diagnostic tool to determine where you think you are as a group or some of your schools are on their sustainability journey.
- Use this as a guide as to which actions might be appropriate to focus on next. Locate these on the site and share the actions with your settings.
- You may use it to decide to prioritise one or two pillars.
- Talk to your settings about their journey and engage them in your group's broader journey.
- Use this guide to show how much progress you've made and celebrate the success of your settings and group!

Visualising the journey

Coming soon! A tool to help with your journey mapping

 Milestone

Milestone Map



Key

Sustainability Fundamentals

Decarbonisation and Energy Efficiency

Climate Adaptation and Resilience

Biodiversity and Green Infrastructure

Climate Education and Green Skills

1 Setting the groundwork

2 Taking the first steps

3 Developing your practice

4 Learning to lead

5 Advanced actions

Create a sustainability working group

Agree a sustainability vision

Understand any compliance requirements

Prioritise the first steps of your sustainability journey

Develop a short-term Climate Action Plan

Complete a CPD audit

Encourage your parent voice

Establish a regular travel survey

Complete an energy review

Understand the types of emissions (Scopes) that contribute to your setting's carbon footprint

Identify some quick wins to decarbonise your

Develop a behaviour change programme

Develop a sustainability policy

Develop a sustainability strategy

Develop an energy re-procurement plan

Identify some Scope 3 quick wins

Calculate your carbon footprint

Develop your Net Zero Vision

Develop a

Develop your Supply Chain re-procurement plan

Develop a CPD programme

Align all policies and strategies with your Sustainability Policy and Strategy

Identify some long-term Scope 3 interventions

Develop a decarbonisation strategy

Develop a plan for Net Zero

Improve your carbon

Develop a long-term Climate Action Plan

Establish collaborative working practices with all suppliers

Seek a costed appraisal of your decarbonisation plan

Publish your first annual emissions report

Identify a specialist to audit your adaptation plan

Embed environmental considerations into your decision making

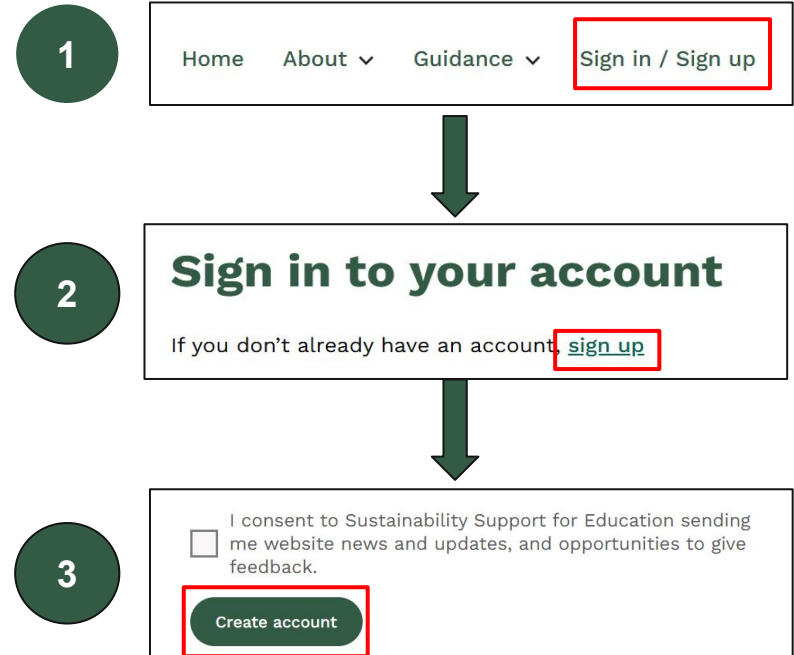
Navigating the site

Creating an account

Encourage your individual settings to create accounts.

Benefits of creating an account: It gives you access to a range of functionality on the site.

- Enables your settings to filter searches based on setting type
- Allows your settings to save content they like to come back to later.
- Allows you to make specific lists of recommended actions that you can save and share with colleagues.
- Gives you familiarity with how the site works so that you can walk your setting through the process.



Navigating the site

Adding multiple settings to an account

If you are in a small MAT, you can register as one user and add all the settings to your account.

This isn't advisable if you're in a medium to large sized group.

HOW: Once you have added a setting to your account, you can add multiple settings. This needs to be done manually by clicking on 'Add a setting'.

For larger MAT, we don't recommend this and we can provide you with the data on which schools in your group have signed up.

1

My profile

Account information

Education settings

Saved

Education settings

For each setting that you're associated with, you can set preferences about the setting and priorities.

Setting name

Setting postcode

Bacon's College

SE16 6AT

[View details](#) / [Edit](#)

Add a setting

Exploring actions

Sustainability Journey

The sustainability journey is structured around **aims**.

These are groups of related actions arranged in a logical sequence. To help settings progress from fledgling to advanced actions. This framework helps settings and plan their next steps effectively.

- Take a look at topics you are less familiar with to get ideas on the kind of actions settings can take
- Use the site to identify specific resources to support a school to complete actions you are discussing.

Topics

Explore actions **by topic**, rather than following a set sequence.

This approach allows settings to:

- Focus on topics that are most relevant to their current priorities (e.g., biodiversity or waste).
- Allows settings to pick and choose which actions are of interest to them.

Advising your settings on Actions

Selecting Appropriate Actions

- Consider what progress has already been made
- Your unique context and scale
- Your approach to autonomy vs steering your schools
- Be ambitious but realistic
- Be guided by the sequenced steps on the site
- Ask for help when needed - draw on use in person support from the Climate Ambassadors or Lets Go Zero Climate Action Advisors

Create lists

Why create and share lists with your settings?

- Save actions to a list to prioritise and return to later.
- Your settings can use the lists you create to form the foundation of a Climate Action Plan.
- Create lists for your settings to maximise the support you can give and save them time.
- We have created a number of these suggested lists. Within your strategic role supporting your MAT and schools, we know you might be interested in:
 - Oversight and Governance
 - Reporting and Data
 - Developing leadership
 - Facilitating buy-in and action
 - Taking advantage of funding opportunities

1

Assess the current sustainability position of your setting



Speak to your staff and children or young people (where appropriate) to identify what actions you are already taking to become more sustainable, and where there are opportunities for improvement.

Low cost One off action

2

[Home](#)

[About](#) ▾

[Guidance](#) ▾

[Saved](#)



3

Edit

Share list

Download list

Sample lists to share

Early Years: Focus on outdoor learning and improving wellbeing and connection to nature.

- Promote the benefits of using outdoor learning spaces to your stakeholders
- Introduce outdoor activities as part of learning

First 10 actions for an EY setting [HERE](#).

Primaryes: Focus on building the groundwork.

- Assess the current sustainability position of your setting
- Understand what data is available across all areas of sustainability
- Consult your community on creating sustainability aspirations
- Identify your sustainability priorities
- Agree a sustainability vision
- Start to build a whole-setting awareness of sustainability

View Primaryes Suggestions List [HERE](#).

Secondaries: Focus on taking the first steps.

- Create a sustainability working group
- Appoint a sustainability focussed governor
- Understand your energy use
- Understand how people travel to your setting
- Conduct a waste audit.

View Secondaries Suggestions List [HERE](#).

Lists to share with your settings

Choose the ones that are relevant to you and share them with your settings:

- 'I'm looking for all the best audits'
- 'I want to improve the sustainability related data my setting has, and use this to drive insights for action'
- 'My settings are just getting started and need to do some planning to develop the building blocks for success'
- 'My settings have made some good progress but they're struggling to get senior leadership buy-in'
- 'School grounds and biodiversity are important to my settings, get them started on improving it'
- 'Cost savings are an important driver for my group and my settings for climate action. Help me take the next steps'
- 'Community engagement is a motivating driver for my settings. What climate action can I take in this vein?'

Saving aims

Aims are a key group of related actions that are in a sequence to show settings the journey through their sustainability target. These provide a structured way to navigate sustainability actions.

You can save all actions associated with an aim automatically into one list.

1

**Sustainability journey**
Find aims that are suitable for your setting, based on what you've done so far.

**Topic**
Actions and resources relevant to your community's other priorities or interests.

**Setting the groundwork**
[View this stage >](#)

Your setting might be completely new to sustainability, or just starting to think about it. Your current aim may be to put structures in place, like regular meetings, to enable progress.

2

**Work towards an aim**
These are key groups of actions that will help you progress in your sustainability journey.

Sustainability fundamentals (4)

Get ready to start your sustainability journey
[Sustainability fundamentals](#)

Agree the roles and responsibilities you'll need to make progress in sustainability. Raise awareness of the importance of this work among your staff, learners and community, so they want to get involved.

5 actions ▾

3

[Save all actions to list](#) ☆

Stage
[Setting the groundwork](#)

Complete this aim next
[Start to understand your setting's context and opportunities](#)

Create a sustainability working group
Assemble a team of your staff members and stakeholders to collaborate on sustainability projects. This team will discuss, plan and implement sustainable practices.

 Milestone  Low cost  One off action

Things to get you started as a MAT

Depending on the size and scale of your MAT, some of the actions on the site will be relevant to you in your central role. Choose the ones that are relevant to you and begin or progress on your MAT's sustainability journey:

- ['I want to understand my starting point and do a MAT level Carbon Footprint assessment'](#)
This will save your settings time in doing individual assessments, and you may hold lots of the data centrally.
- Help me find [funding opportunities](#) to support decarbonisation works across my settings and [help me apply for them](#).
- [I want to understand more about the potential for decarbonisation across my settings](#), and need help to [commission decarbonisation surveys](#).
- [Help me carve out some capacity, make the most of it and set some priorities](#).
- ['I want to start tackling Scope 3 emissions'](#). Where do I start?

Encouraging collaboration in Groups

A whole-institution approach to sustainability is essential to driving long term climate action. This applies to within a setting and within Groups. We know that communicating plans and activity is important to you and we encourage this behaviour on the site.

There are a number of specific actions that highlight this, for example:

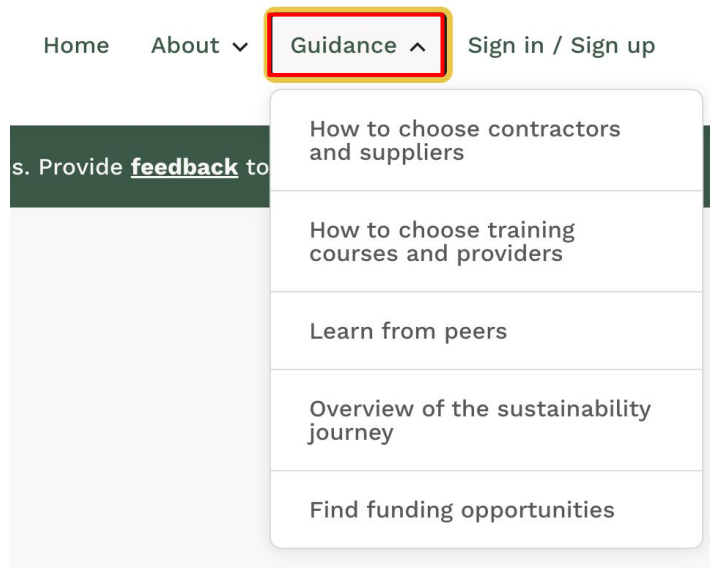
- [Collaborate on sustainability in your group](#)
- [Collaborate with your group on climate risk assessment and management](#)
- [Share your Climate Action Plan with stakeholders](#)

Understanding guidance

The Guidance pages have been developed to fill key gaps in the sector that we know the sector struggles with. They help you and your settings:

- Source funding
- Identify suitable training providers
- Identify suitable contractors and suppliers to progress on your sustainability journey.

You can share these pages direct with your settings, and try to embed their practice into your behaviour.



Getting settings started

In this guide, we have suggested ways that you can use the website to support your group's sustainability journey and your interaction with your settings.

Key takeaways:

- Encourage your central sustainability lead (if you have one) and your settings to create a profile on the site and explore its content.
- Ask them to identify key sustainability areas of interest and access relevant actions and resources.
- Ask them to select a few actions or aims that align with your group's or their setting's journey, review the associated resources, and plan initial steps toward implementation.

Please share with us feedback and how you're getting on!

Thank you

TPXimpact



United Learning
The best in everyone™



Blue Marble™



**Sustainability
Support for
Education**